

BioEdit Institutional Biosafety Committee Meeting Minutes

Date: Thursday, January 22, 2026

Time: 11:00 am – 12:00 pm EST

Virtual

IBC Member Attendance:

Name	Member Role/Expertise	Present/Absent
E. Helmes	Chair	Present
R. Van Dorn	Secretary/Contact	Present
D. Gangaiah	Recombinant/synthetic nucleic acid molecules; infectious disease	Present
D. Susanti	Microbiology	Absent
S. Manuja	Animal Containment	Present
A. Wells	Non-Affiliated Community	Present
S. Mowery	Non-Affiliated Community	Present

Quorum met.

Non-IBC Members in Attendance: A. McMillan, D. Adeniyi

The meeting was called to order at 8:03 am PST/11:03 am EST

1. Conflict of interest Disclosure: S. Manuja is the PI for project BE-101 Clinical Development and will abstain from voting on that project.
2. IBC Project Forms
 - a. BE-101 Product Development
 - i. Project Summary: BE-101 is a candidate veterinary biologic product comprised of two live recombinant *Limosilactobacillus reuteri* (LR) strains for use in chickens. This product is in late development stage, and BioEdit expects approval from USDA Center for Veterinary Biologics (CVB) in 2026.

As part of the development of this product, the contract manufacturer, which is a licensed USDA facility, will produce the lyophilized (freeze-dried) poultry product containing the two live recombinant LR strains using greater than 10L fermentors. At BioEdit, small scale fermentations (not greater than 10L) will be conducted. The manufacturing process was described. BioEdit and the contract manufacturer on behalf of BioEdit, may also conduct *in vitro* assays to support commercial, clinical, and regulatory activities.

- ii. Applicable NIH Guidelines Section: III-D and III-E

- iii. Risk Assessment Discussion: The IBC had no discussion topics regarding the risk assessment for the project.
- iv. Training: Training has been verified
- v. Containment Level: BSL 1
- vi. Motion: S. Mowery moved to approve the Project as presented. S. Manuja seconded. Abstention: S. Manuja. Motion passed.

b. BE-101 Clinical Development

- i. Project Summary: Same first paragraph as above 2.a.i.

A final requirement of licensure is that BiomEdit conduct a field safety trial (FST) at three commercial sites in the US; this FST is planned for Q1 2026. The USDA CVB has issued a Finding of No Significant Impact (FONSI) letter stating that USDA has considered the environmental effects including the impacts on animal safety, public health, and environmental safety, and concluded that the implementation of the FST with this investigational veterinary product does not present a significant risk. Prior to shipping the investigational veterinary product to the three sites, formal CVB approval to ship will be obtained via the 9 CFR 103.3 permit process.

Other clinical studies are planned for Q1 and Q2 of 2026. Approvals from USDA CVB will be obtained before any BE-101 material will be shipped to any of the study sites.

- ii. Applicable NIH Guidelines Section: III-D
- iii. Risk Assessment Discussion: The IBC discussed the USDA FONSI and 9 CFR 103.3 permit process. When available, the USDA-approved 103.3 permits will be submitted to the IBC. A question arose regarding the initial application. Another question arose regarding the booster administration. A third question came up regarding the conduct of the safety trial. All questions were addressed satisfactorily.
- iv. Training: Training has been verified
- v. Containment Level: BSL 1/Field Study
- vi. Requirements:
 - 1. 9 CFR 103.3 approvals from USDA to be provided to IBC.
 - 2. FST disposition method for any mortalities to be provided to the IBC.
- vii. Motion: R. Van Dorn moved to approve the Project as presented. A. Wells seconded. Abstention: S. Manuja. Motion passed.

3. Discussion Topics

- a. BiomEdit-Sponsored Work Conducted by and at Other Facilities with Their Own IBC and IBC Review Process
 - i. R. Van Dorn communicated that there will be BiomEdit-sponsored work conducted at other institutions involving recombinant or synthetic nucleic acid molecules. Many of these institutions will have their own IBCs that need to review and approve the research being conducted. It was suggested that if external IBCs reviewed/approved the research being conducted on behalf of BiomEdit, then this information could be shared with the BiomEdit IBC.
 - ii. Motion: E. Helmes moved to allow the BiomEdit IBC to review IBC reports from external institutions where BiomEdit-sponsored research projects are conducted. After such review, the BiomEdit IBC would vote on such projects. S. Manuja seconds. The motion passed unanimously.
- b. Timing of next IBC meeting
 - i. The next IBC meeting will be scheduled for mid to late March. R. Van Dorn will send out a request for IBC member availability.

The meeting was adjourned at 8:52 am PST/11:52 am EST.